

COMPARISON · LEDGER · PROSE

compare-table

Multi-row comparison table with consistent columns.

Where the four substance contracts come from.

SUBSTANCE	AUTHOR WRITES	RENDERER	OUTPUT
prose	headings, paragraphs, lists	Marp markdown → semantic HTML	DOM
structure	nested lists with conventions	lib/*.js post-processor	DOM
series	tabular DSL (axes + datapoints)	chart-family kernel	SVG
graph	external graph language	external CLI (mmdc, future d2)	SVG

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When NOT to reach for compare-table.

Cells full of prose. Long sentences in a table cell wrap awkwardly and force the column wider. Move to [verdict-grid](#) for criteria with body text, or [cards-stack](#) for full prose rows.

More than 6 rows. Past 6 rows the table density crowds the slide. Split into two slides or summarise the rows that don't differentiate.

State-marker rows. When most cells are pass/fail/partial badges, the right layout is [obligation-matrix](#) or [verdict-grid](#). compare-table is for textual values.

See also.

RELATED COMPONENTS

- `compare-prose` — exactly two options with prose bodies
- `verdict-grid` — options scored against criteria with pass/partial/fail badges
- `obligation-matrix` — many regimes compared against shared obligations
- `cards-stack` — each row needs full-prose breathing room rather than a tabular cell